



**MINUTES OF FRIENDS OF TELFORD TOWN PARK MEETING
WEDNESDAY 11th FEBRUARY 2015
VISITOR CENTRE, 6PM**

Present: Colin Thompson (Vice Chair), Chris Pettman (Treasurer), Brenda Pettman,
Kathryn Allen, John Trubshaw, Nicola Allen (Park Manager),
Apologies: Eileen Smith

Minutes of last meeting.

Agreed and accepted

Matters Arising.

Rachel Phillips would be joining the gardening group to help and advise.

£30.00 outstanding income from Santa fun run. £1800.00 total means £900.00 each to
RNIB and Guide Dogs

The pull up promotional banner has been purchased and was displayed by CP for all to see. The purchase of a second item was further discussed and agreed.

There was still £32.50 remaining from the grants to the Green Brigade project by Nedge ward and Baron Davenport. Nicola agreed to purchase PPE for that amount and supply invoice to CP to enable closure.

CT would be updating the website.

CP informed that the Explore newsletter would be out at the end of February but, due to the editorial about the Green Brigade success and the Friends part in it, would be larger than usual and cost more to produce. This was accepted and agreed.

'Spring into the Park' was discussed and the possibility of the Friends carrying out an activity in which the public could get involved was raised. Discussion favoured a location near the Silkin Way education area, possibly some scrub bashing adjacent the twin tracks?

CP advised that HSBC corporate volunteer day was to go ahead, JT to assist. It would be a hedge laying session at the entrance to the park from the Grange Pool area.

Interim Treasurers Report.

CP reported that there remained £432.99 in the main account and £1841.70 in Santa Fun Run account. Explore newsletter would cost around £300.00 of the main account and, with £900.00 to each charity, fun run account would be left with £41.70.

CP stated that, as in previous years, he had set budget for 2015-16 to include promotional, insurance and stationary and Junior Rangers. It also included a contingency fund for the purchase of bird boxes, replacement tools etc.

CP informed the meeting that he was looking for sponsorship for Santa Fun Run in the hope that, if it could cover the outgoings, there would be more to donate to the charities?

PR Report.

CP reported on his recent participation in a Dragon's Den type event arranged by CVS. Lots of advice from local businesses about raising profile. Follow ups to be actioned

Events.

NA informed the meeting that a bird walk and bird feeder / insect house workshop was taking place at visitor centre on the coming Saturday (14th)

Stokes funfair would be on site during half term.

There was to be a trial junior park run on Sunday 15th Feb and it was intended that the regular events would begin on Sunday 29th March.

There would be special offers on the golf during half term.

Telford half marathon would take place 19th April

21st April would see Monster Trucks arriving in the arena.

CP advised that FOTTP would have a promotional information stand in town centre on Friday & Saturday 24th / 25th April and appealed for support to attend.

Park Maintenance.

NA informed that the rangers had finished the coppicing started by the Green Brigade. The pergola in the gardens was to be renovated. The new management plan for the park was in draft and being looked over by with Becky Eade.

The ongoing problems with the paths surfacing was still suffering from unsuitable weather conditions and would be continued when more favourable.

Training.

NA said that there were no courses in the pipeline at present. With 4 applications for the education officer position, vacant since Catherine began Maternity leave, it was hoped that the position would soon be filled and that the education / training programme could kick on again?

Junior Rangers.

This project still waiting a definitive decision on insurance responsibilities.

Green Brigade.

This trial project has run its 12 weeks and was now completed. JT reported that, following interviews arranged through the council, 4 of the young people had secured apprenticeships.

TGSP.

CT informed the meeting that within the parameters of the green spaces survey, Telford Town Park ticked all of the boxes.

AOB.

CP asked about repairs to the water feature / fountain in the gardens. NA advised that the job was on the list for when weather improves.

NA told the meeting that the snack bar and ice cream vendor licences were currently out to tender.

The LNR application was to go before cabinet on 27th February and the application for planning permission on Randlay lorry Park would be presented on 26th. It was expected that work will begin in June?

CP asked about the continued presence of Herris fencing on the Malinslee side of the park, adding that he felt that the subsidence must have stabilised by now? NA advised that it was intended to survey the site to establish safety and stability.

With no further business, meeting closed at 19.05

Date of next meeting: Wednesday 11th March 2015, 6pm at the Visitor Centre.

As it is now dark in the evening, members are welcome to drive vehicles into the Park via Southwater Way and park at the back of Withy Pool by the fishing peg. Please drive slowly and display hazard warning lights at all times.